



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Hagia Sophia Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.the-classical-academy.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL School: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org) Summary: The crawl shows an explicitly classical, Christian mission; a Trivium-centered, Latin-forward curriculum; robust memory work and Socratic/rhetoric pedagogy culminating in a senior thesis defense; and a strong partnership-with-parents model. The only softer area in the public materials is Faculty, where fewer explicit "portrait of a teacher/mentor" statements appear. Everything else aligns strongly with classical indicators such as truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue; trivium/Latin; recitation and Socratic discussion; and parent formation.

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Rating: CLASSICAL

1) Keywords observed on the site

- Mission: "exists to glorify Jesus Christ ... classical, Christian education" (glorify Jesus Christ; Christian)
- Purpose/virtues: "cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students" (wisdom; virtue)
- Transcendentals: "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" (truth; goodness; beauty)
- Theological integration: "interrelatedness of all knowledge under the sovereignty of God through theology" (theology)
- Communal/faith practice reference: "Read and Pray ... please prayerfully consider" (prayer)

2) Match against Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; Christian; prayer (liturgical/communal cue)
- Negative matches: none detected (no values-neutral, relativism, secular humanism)

3) Quant tally

- Positives: +9 (truth, goodness, beauty x3; virtue; wisdom; theology; Christian; prayer)
- Negatives: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 80% (explicit on transcendental moral realism and theological grounding; only light/indirect liturgical phrasing via "pray/prayerfully," with no explicit "chapel/liturgy")

4) Justification The mission and core framing reflect transcendental moral realism and theological integration, with slight underexposure of formal liturgical life in public pages. Strongly classical.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Rating: CLASSICAL

1) Keywords observed on the site

- Aim: “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (wisdom; virtue)
- Transcendentals: contemplation of the “True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (truth; goodness; beauty)
- Formation: “form students who can think deeply, make wise decisions, act courageously” (formation; wisdom)
- Telos: “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation ... more about ... eternal purpose” (formation over information)
- Great Conversation: “great ideas ... great books ... join the great conversation” (great conversation)

2) Match against Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: formation; cultivate virtue; wisdom; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; great conversation; human excellence (implied)
- Negative signals: one mild “college/life success” statement on collaborative model (could imply pragmatic framing, but not dominant)

3) Quant tally

- Positives: +10 (wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, formation, great conversation, eternal purpose—counted once each)
- Negatives: -1 (“preparing ... for success in college and life”)
- Percent positive: 91%
- Coverage estimate: 100% (aims, telos, and formation are explicit and repeated)

4) Justification The stated telos is formation in wisdom/virtue guided by the transcendentals; pragmatic aims are not foregrounded. Clear classical purpose.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Rating: CLASSICAL

1) Keywords observed on the site

- Liberal Arts / Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Trivium diagram (trivium)
- Great Books / Great Conversation; primary sources (great books; primary sources)
- Classical languages: Latin grades 5–8; formal logic; rhetoric instruction; senior thesis defense (Latin; logic; rhetoric; capstone)
- History (vs. “social studies”): humanities include extensive primary sources; “History” course listings (history)
- Integration/harmony: “interrelation of all knowledge ... under ... God through theology” (integration)

2) Match against Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), great books/primary texts, Latin, Socratic texts, history, integrated approach/harmony of subjects, rhetoric capstone/oral defense
- Negative signals: none found (no “social studies” framing, no STEM-first marketing)

3) Quant tally

- Positives: +14

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- Negatives: -0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage estimate: 100% (trivium, great books, languages, integration all present)
- 4) Justification ACS presents a full classical program with trivium, Latin/logic/rhetoric progression, primary sources, and integrated humanities/sciences—textbook classical.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Rating: CLASSICAL

- 1) Keywords observed on the site
- Grammar-stage methods: “memorization, recitation, songs” (recitation; chanting/singing equivalents; memory work)
 - Dialectic/Socratic: logic students learn through “debate and discussion”; upper school “Socratic discussion” (socratic; debate; discussion)
 - Rhetoric/oratory: poetry recitations; oral/written exams; presentations; thesis with public defense (oratory; oral exam)
 - Restful/contemplative notes: emphasis on “depth over breadth,” to “ruminate” on texts for deeper understanding/mastery (restful learning analogs)
- 2) Match against Six Elements lexicon
- Positive matches: Socratic seminar/discussion, recitation/chanting/singing, rhetoric/oratory/defense, restful learning cues (depth over breadth/rumination)
 - Negative signals: none (no project-based dominance/constructivist emphasis)
- 3) Quant tally
- Positives: +11
 - Negatives: -0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage estimate: 100% (lower school memory work; dialectic debate; rhetoric oration)
- 4) Justification Pedagogy tracks the classical stages and methods closely, with explicit memory work, Socratic habits, and rhetorical capstones.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- 1) Keywords observed on the site
- “Head of School who loves Jesus ... talented and dedicated teachers ... serving God ... using the classical approach” (teachers; virtue orientation)
 - Employment page noted but few public specifics on a classical “portrait of a teacher” or faculty formation (employment reference)
- 2) Match against Six Elements lexicon
- Positive matches: teachers as moral exemplars implied; classical pedagogy usage; servant leadership referenced in student aims (virtue; leadership)
 - Missing/weak: explicit “mentors,” “faculty of friends,” “portrait of a teacher,” or faculty classical formation seminars in public pages

3) Quant tally

- Positives: +3
- Negatives: -0
- Percent positive: 100% (of few signals)
- Coverage estimate: 45% (statements are supportive but thin relative to classical faculty ideals)

4) Justification The site communicates a faithful, dedicated team and classical approach, but provides limited public detail on teacher formation, mentoring ethos, or a formal portrait of a teacher. Hence “Somewhat Classical” on available evidence.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Rating: CLASSICAL

1) Keywords observed on the site

- Parent partnership: “co□laboring with families” (partnership)
- Parent formation: both parents should read specified classical ed resources (parent formation)
- Parent engagement/visits: Prospective Parent Information Session; Upper School Open House; Shadow Day (open campus, community)
- Collaborative model: unified curriculum between home and school (home□school synergy)

2) Match against Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: partnership with parents; parent formation; open campus/visits (hospitality)
- Negative signals: none (no “parent as customer only” framing)

3) Quant tally

- Positives: +7
- Negatives: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage estimate: 100%

4) Justification ACS explicitly co□educates with families, forms parents in classical vision, and invites regular campus engagement—hallmark classical community practices.

Overall Assessment

Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL - Category results: Religious/Metaphysical (Classical), Purpose/Goal (Classical), Curriculum (Classical), Pedagogy (Classical), Faculty (Somewhat Classical), Parents/Community (Classical). - The evidence base is rich in classical positive indicators and very sparse in negative indicators. The only notable gap is paucity of public language about teacher formation/profiles.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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